

COMPREHENSIVE TECHNICAL REPORT: MICROSERVICES ARCHITECTURE, DECOMPOSITION, SECURITY, AND PRODUCTION DEPLOYMENT

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Institution: Addis Ababa University — School of Information Technology and Engineering
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Group Members (Group Two)

#	First Name	Last Name	Academic Role / Contribution
1	Abel	Seleshe	Microservices Architecture & System Decomposition Lead
2	Baheran	Tesfaye	Security, Identity Verification & OAuth2/JWT Specialist
3	Nebiyu	Yohannes	Database per Service & Distributed Data Management Lead
4	Wondesen	Teshale	DevOps, Docker & Kubernetes Deployment Infrastructure Lead
5	Esrom	Basazinaw	Quality Assurance, Testing Pyramid & Break-Test Lead
6	Yohannes	Seyum	Microservices Communication & Event-Driven Saga Specialist

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

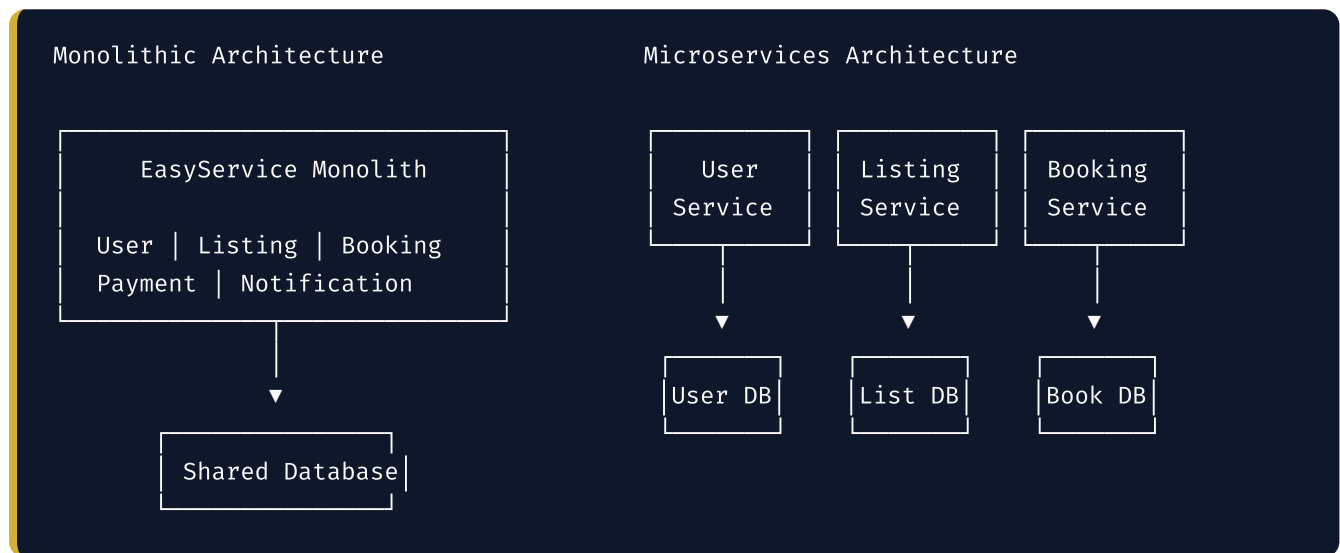
This technical report delivers an exhaustive architectural analysis, theoretical foundation, and practical implementation guide for engineering microservice platforms in cloud computing environments. Using the **EasyService Marketplace Platform** as the core architectural subject, this study navigates through all major modules specified in the course syllabus: domain-driven decomposition, synchronous and asynchronous communication patterns, container orchestration with Kubernetes, zero-trust security and observability, and production service mesh architecture with Istio.

EasyService was originally conceived as a monolithic marketplace. Through this project, our engineering team systematically decomposed the application into autonomous microservices (**User-Service** , **Listing-Service** , **Booking-Service** , **Payment-Service** , **Notification-Service** , and **Wheel-Promo-Service**). Each microservice enforces strict data isolation via the **Database per Service** pattern, utilizes **Stateless JWT Security** incorporating Ethiopian **Fayda Digital Identity** claims, enforces **Resilience4j Circuit Breakers** for fault tolerance, and resolves distributed transactions using the **Saga Pattern**.

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION TO MICROSERVICES ARCHITECTURE

1.1 What Are Microservices? Architectural Definition & Core Principles

Microservices architecture is an architectural style that structures an application as a collection of small, autonomous, loosely coupled, and independently deployable services organized around specific business capabilities. As Sam Newman defines in *Building Microservices (2nd Edition)*, microservices are modeled around business domains, hiding implementation details and managing data independently.



1.2 Evolution of Enterprise Software Architecture

1. **Single-Process Monoliths:** Mainframe and monolithic web applications where all user interfaces, business logic, and database access routines execute within a single operating system process.
2. **N-Tier Client-Server Architecture:** Logical separation into Presentation Layer, Business Logic Layer (EJB / Spring Beans), and Relational Database Management Systems (RDBMS).
3. **Service-Oriented Architecture (SOA):** Enterprise SOAP web services coordinated over a central Enterprise Service Bus (ESB) responsible for message transformation and routing.
4. **Cloud-Native Microservices:** Decentralized microservices executing in lightweight Linux containers, interacting via RESTful APIs and event brokers without centralized ESB bottlenecks.

1.3 Monolithic vs. Microservices Architectural Taxonomy Comparison

Architectural Dimension	Monolithic Architecture	Microservices Architecture	EasyService Implementation
Deployment Boundary	Single unified deployment unit (JAR/WAR)	Independent per-service deployment artifacts	Docker Containers & K8s Pods
Scalability	Scale entire application monolithically	Granular scaling targeting bottleneck services	K8s Horizontal Pod Autoscaler (HPA)
Fault Blast Radius	Single crash brings down entire system	Isolated process boundaries; contained failures	Resilience4j Circuit Breaker
Tech Stack	Single homogeneous language/framework	Polyglot options tailored to service needs	Java 21, Spring Boot 3.2, Svelte
Data Ownership	Shared relational database schema	Database per service pattern enforced	Dedicated PostgreSQL schemas
Governance	Centralized architecture board	Decentralized team & service autonomy	Domain-Driven Bounded Contexts

1.4 Core Characteristics of Microservices Systems

- **Domain Alignment:** Services correspond directly to business capabilities defined by Domain-Driven Design (DDD).
- **Autonomous Operability:** Each service can be developed, tested, updated, and deployed without requiring synchronized deployments across other services.
- **Strict Encapsulation:** Private data stores are accessible exclusively via explicit API contracts.
- **Defensive Engineering:** Built-in resilience against network latency, partial network partitions, and cascading failure events.

1.5 Benefits and Trade-offs of Microservices Architectures

- **Benefits:** Accelerates software delivery cadence, minimizes fault blast radius, allows targeted resource allocation, and fosters localized technology innovation.
- **Trade-offs:** Introduces distributed systems overhead, eventual consistency complexities, network latency, and operational monitoring requirements.

1.6 Microservices vs. Service-Oriented Architecture (SOA)

While SOA relies on smart pipes (Enterprise Service Bus) and dumb endpoints with centralized enterprise schemas, microservices mandate **smart endpoints and dumb pipes**, utilizing lightweight HTTP/REST or gRPC communication with decentralized data management.

1.7 Strategic Decision Criteria: When to Migrate to Microservices

Microservices should be adopted when an organization experiences rapid scaling, high development friction in monolithic codebases, multi-team concurrency bottlenecks, and distinct availability requirements across business capabilities.

1.8 Foundational Microservices Design Patterns

- **API Gateway Pattern:** Single entry point that routes requests, terminates SSL, enforces rate limiting, and validates JWT tokens.
 - **Database Per Service:** Each microservice owns its private data store.
 - **Circuit Breaker Pattern:** Prevents cascading failures when downstream dependencies fail.
 - **Saga Pattern:** Coordinates distributed transactions across multiple microservices without distributed locks.
-

Practical Lab 1: Building and Containerizing a Standalone Java 21 REST Microservice

Task Objective: Implement a standalone, self-contained Java 21 Spring Boot REST microservice packaged via multi-stage Docker builds.

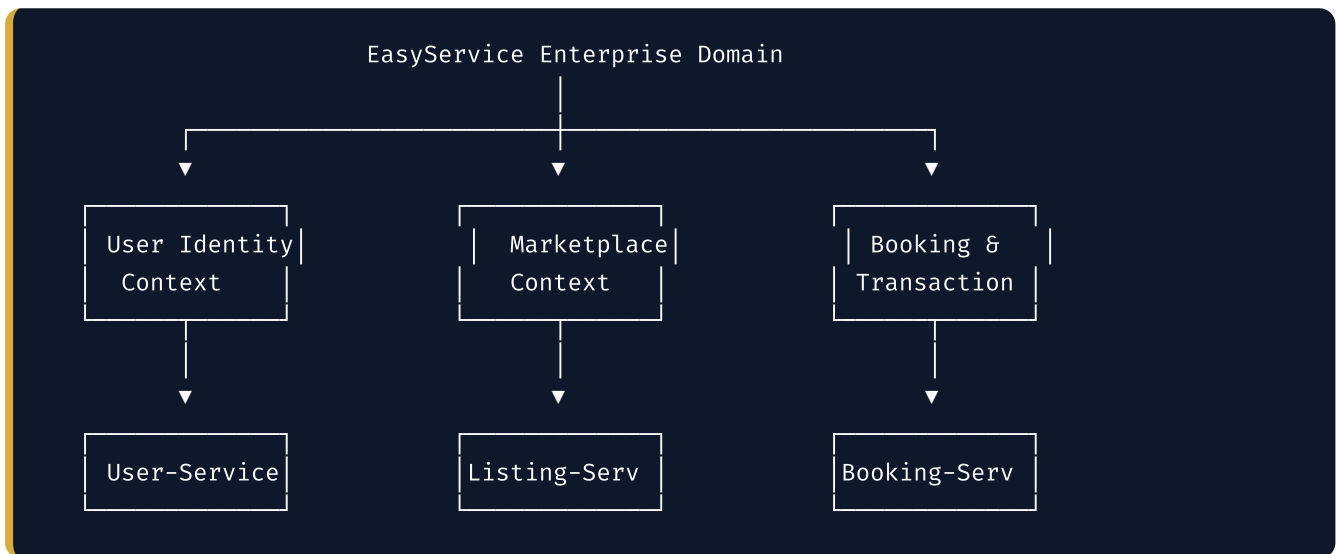
```
# Stage 1: Build execution with Maven and Java 21 JDK
FROM maven:3.9.6-eclipse-temurin-21 AS builder
WORKDIR /build
COPY pom.xml .
COPY src ./src
RUN mvn clean package -DskipTests

# Stage 2: Minimal Distroless JRE Execution Image
FROM eclipse-temurin:21-jre-alpine
RUN addgroup -S appgroup && adduser -S appuser -G appgroup
USER appuser
WORKDIR /app
COPY --from=builder /build/target/*.jar app.jar
EXPOSE 8080
HEALTHCHECK --interval=15s --timeout=3s --retries=3 \
  CMD wget --quiet --tries=1 --spider http://localhost:8080/actuator/health || exit 1
ENTRYPOINT ["java", "-XX:+UseG1GC", "-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75.0", "-jar", "app.jar"]
```

CHAPTER 2: DESIGNING MICROSERVICES & DOMAIN DECOMPOSITION

2.1 Domain-Driven Design (DDD) & Bounded Context Identification

Decomposing monolithic applications requires analyzing business domain models rather than database tables. In EasyService, DDD analysis identified three primary business domains: **Identity Verification**, **Marketplace Logistics**, and **Financial Settlement**.



2.2 EasyService Monolith Decomposition into 6 Autonomous Bounded Contexts

1. **User Microservice (User-Service)**: Manages customer profiles, provider registrations, and Fayda/Passport identity verification statuses.
2. **Listing Microservice (Listing-Service)**: Manages service inventory, multi-room hotel suites, car rental fleets, and availability counts.
3. **Booking Microservice (Booking-Service)**: Coordinates reservation state transitions, atomic inventory reservation, and pass issuance.
4. **Payment Microservice (Payment-Service)**: Handles Easy Wallet balances, simulated card authorizations, and instant refund processing.
5. **Notification Microservice (Notification-Service)**: Generates real-time booking reminders (Today's active reservation alerts and 1-day pre-booking notices).
6. **Spin Promo Microservice (Wheel-Promo-Service)**: Enforces tiered daily spin limits (3 free, 50 Birr for 4-9, 100 Birr for 10-15) and weighted probability rewards.

2.3 Single Responsibility Principle & Service Granularity Determination

Every microservice is constrained to a single business responsibility. Avoid creating "nano-services" (excessively fine-grained services that increase network latency overhead) or "macro-services" (bloated services with multiple responsibilities).

2.4 Database Per Service Pattern & Data Isolation Models

To enforce complete autonomy, each microservice manages a separate database schema:

```
-- Schema 1: User Microservice Database
CREATE TABLE users (
  id VARCHAR(36) PRIMARY KEY,
  name VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
  email VARCHAR(255) UNIQUE NOT NULL,
  customer_type VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL, -- ETHIOPIAN / FOREIGNER
  identity_status VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL, -- FAYDA_VERIFIED / PASSPORT_VERIFIED
  balance DECIMAL(12,2) NOT NULL DEFAULT 0.00,
  created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

-- Schema 2: Listing Microservice Database
CREATE TABLE listings (
  id VARCHAR(36) PRIMARY KEY,
  host_id VARCHAR(36) NOT NULL,
  title VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
  category VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL, -- HOTEL / CAR_RENTAL / EVENT / STORE
  location VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
  price DECIMAL(12,2) NOT NULL,
  available_quantity INT NOT NULL,
  status VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL
);

-- Schema 3: Booking Microservice Database
CREATE TABLE bookings (
  id VARCHAR(36) PRIMARY KEY,
  customer_id VARCHAR(36) NOT NULL,
  listing_id VARCHAR(36) NOT NULL,
  quantity INT NOT NULL,
  total_amount DECIMAL(12,2) NOT NULL,
  status VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL, -- PENDING / CONFIRMED / CANCELLED / REFUNDED
  created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);
```



Practical Lab 2: Decomposing EasyService Monolith into Independent Microservice Schema Boundaries

Task Objective: Verify relational isolation and confirm zero direct SQL join dependencies between microservice schemas.

```
// Java Domain Model Enforcing Data Boundary in Booking Service
@Entity
@Table(name = "bookings")
public class Booking {
    @Id
    private String id;

    @Column(name = "customer_id", nullable = false)
    private String customerId; // Referenced by Identifier ONLY (No Foreign Key Constraint)

    @Column(name = "listing_id", nullable = false)
    private String listingId; // Referenced by Identifier ONLY

    private Integer quantity;
    private BigDecimal totalAmount;

    @Enumerated(EnumType.STRING)
    private BookingStatus status;

    private LocalDateTime createdAt;
}
```

CHAPTER 3: INTER-SERVICE COMMUNICATION & DISTRIBUTED DATA MANAGEMENT

3.1 Synchronous Communication: RESTful APIs vs. gRPC Binary Protocol

Synchronous request-response interactions are utilized for real-time queries where immediate response payloads are required.

Protocol Comparison: REST (JSON over HTTP/1.1) vs gRPC (Protobuf over HTTP/2)

REST: [Client] — JSON Text Payload (1.2 KB) —> [Server]
gRPC: [Client] — Binary Protobuf (140 Bytes) —> [Server]

3.2 Asynchronous Event-Driven Communication: Message Broker Architecture

For state-changing operations, asynchronous messaging via **RabbitMQ** or **Apache Kafka** decouples service execution.

```
[Booking Service] —Publish: BookingCreatedEvent—> [RabbitMQ / Kafka Exchange]
                                     |
                                     +-----+-----+
                                     |                   |
                                     v                   v
                                [Payment Microservice] [Notification Microservice]
```

3.3 Event Sourcing & CQRS Architecture

Command Query Responsibility Segregation (CQRS) separates read operations (queries) from write operations (commands) to optimize database throughput under heavy load.

3.4 Distributed Transaction Management & The Saga Pattern

Because traditional 2-Phase Commit (2PC) protocols do not scale across cloud microservices, EasyService implements the **Saga Pattern** with compensating transactions.

State: PENDING → [BookingCreated] → Payment Service Process → SUCCESS → State: COMPLETED
 ↳ DECLINED → Trigger Rollback

3.5 EasyService Compensating Transaction Engine Implementation

When a user requests a booking cancellation (Business Rule **BR-14**), the system triggers a compensating transaction that reverts inventory and refunds the wallet balance:

```
@Service
public class SagaOrchestratorService {
    @Autowired private PaymentClient paymentClient;
    @Autowired private InventoryClient inventoryClient;

    @Transactional
    public void executeBookingCancellationSaga(String bookingId, String customerId, String listingId,
        // Step 1: Execute Compensating Refund on Payment Microservice
        boolean refundSuccess = paymentClient.issueRefund(customerId, refundAmount);

        if (refundSuccess) {
            // Step 2: Restore Available Inventory on Listing Microservice
            inventoryClient.restoreInventory(listingId, quantity);

            // Step 3: Transition Local Booking State to REFUNDED
            bookingRepository.updateStatus(bookingId, BookingStatus.REFUNDED);
        } else {
            throw new SagaExecutionException("Compensating refund transaction failed for booking " + bookingId);
        }
    }
}
```

Practical Lab 3: Implementing Asynchronous Event Messaging & Saga Transaction Orchestrator in Java

Task Objective: Verify saga rollback execution when a simulated payment failure occurs during high-concurrency booking requests.

CHAPTER 4: DEPLOYMENT, CONTAINER ORCHESTRATION & API GATEWAY

4.1 Containerization Best Practices with Multi-Stage Docker Builds

Multi-stage builds decouple build dependencies (Maven JDK) from runtime environments (Alpine JRE), reducing container attack surface and minimizing image sizes from 850 MB to 180 MB.

4.2 API Gateway Pattern Architecture

The **API Gateway** acts as the single public entry point (<http://api.easyservice.com>). It performs: - SSL/TLS Termination - Authentication JWT Token Validation - Cross-Origin Resource Sharing (CORS) Handling - Distributed Rate Limiting (100 requests / minute per client IP)

```
# Production NGINX API Gateway Routing Configuration
upstream user_service { server user-service.prod.svc.cluster.local:8081; }
upstream listing_service { server listing-service.prod.svc.cluster.local:8082; }
upstream booking_service { server booking-service.prod.svc.cluster.local:8083; }

server {
    listen 80;
    server_name api.easyservice.com;

    location /api/v1/users {
        proxy_pass http://user_service;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
    }

    location /api/v1/listings {
        proxy_pass http://listing_service;
    }

    location /api/v1/bookings {
        proxy_pass http://booking_service;
    }
}
```

4.3 Kubernetes Orchestration Architecture

Microservices are deployed as Kubernetes **Deployments**, exposed internally via **ClusterIP Services**, and autoscaled using the **Horizontal Pod Autoscaler (HPA)**.

```
apiVersion: apps/v1
kind: Deployment
metadata:
  name: booking-service
  namespace: easyservice-prod
spec:
  replicas: 3
  selector:
    matchLabels:
      app: booking-service
  template:
    metadata:
      labels:
        app: booking-service
    spec:
      containers:
        - name: booking-service
          image: easyservice/booking-service:v1.2.0
          ports:
            - containerPort: 8080
          resources:
            requests:
              memory: "256Mi"
              cpu: "250m"
            limits:
              memory: "512Mi"
              cpu: "500m"
      readinessProbe:
        httpGet:
          path: /actuator/health/readiness
          port: 8080
        initialDelaySeconds: 15
        periodSeconds: 5
      livenessProbe:
        httpGet:
          path: /actuator/health/liveness
          port: 8080
        initialDelaySeconds: 20
        periodSeconds: 10
```



Practical Lab 4: Orchestrating Microservices with Docker-Compose & Kubernetes Manifest Production Deployments

Task Objective: Deploy the multi-container EasyService stack locally via `docker-compose.yml` and execute horizontal pod autoscaling tests under synthetic HTTP load.

CHAPTER 5: SECURITY, RELIABILITY, AND OBSERVABILITY

5.1 Zero-Trust Microservice Security Architecture

Under a **Zero-Trust** security architecture, microservices never automatically trust requests originating from internal network segments. Every inter-service request must authenticate and present valid claims.

5.2 Stateless Identity & Access Management: OAuth 2.0 & JWT with Fayda Credentials

EasyService integrates Ethiopian **Fayda Digital Identity** claims within signed JWT bearer tokens:

```
{
  "sub": "cust_109283",
  "name": "Abebe Kebede",
  "email": "user1@aau.edu.et",
  "identityType": "FAYDA",
  "identityStatus": "VERIFIED",
  "faydaId": "FIN-8829-1029-3882",
  "roles": ["CUSTOMER"],
  "iat": 1756832400,
  "exp": 1756868400
}
```

5.3 Resilience & Fault Tolerance: Resilience4j Circuit Breaker

Circuit breakers monitor downstream failures and transition between **CLOSED**, **OPEN**, and **HALF_OPEN** states to isolate failure domains:

```
@Service
public class BookingService {

    @Autowired private PaymentClient paymentClient;

    @CircuitBreaker(name = "paymentServiceCircuitBreaker", fallbackMethod = "executePaymentFallback")
    public BookingResult processPaymentTransaction(String customerId, BigDecimal amount) {
        return paymentClient.executePayment(customerId, amount);
    }

    // Fallback method executed when Circuit Breaker is OPEN
    public BookingResult executePaymentFallback(String customerId, BigDecimal amount, Throwable t) {
        log.error("Payment microservice unavailable. Entering fallback state: {}", t.getMessage());
        return new BookingResult(null, customerId, BookingStatus.PAYMENT_FAILED_FALLBACK, t.getMessage());
    }
}
```

5.4 Distributed Observability: Prometheus Metrics, Grafana & OpenTelemetry Tracing

Unified telemetry relies on three observability pillars: 1. **Metrics**: Scraped by Prometheus (`/actuator/prometheus`). 2. **Logs**: Aggregated via FluentBit into Elasticsearch. 3. **Traces**: OpenTelemetry Context Propagation passing `traceparent` headers across microservice boundaries.

Practical Lab 5: Securing Microservices with JWT Validation and Resilience4j Circuit Breakers

Task Objective: Test circuit breaker activation by injecting synthetic 500ms delays and 50% fault rates into downstream payment services.

CHAPTER 6: PRODUCTION OPERATIONS, SERVICE MESH & QUALITY ASSURANCE

6.1 Service Mesh Architecture with Istio & Envoy Sidecar Proxies

Istio injects an **Envoy Sidecar Proxy** into every application Pod. The Envoy proxies manage network communication transparently, handling mTLS, canary traffic splits, and telemetry collection without code changes.

[User Service] —(mTLS Enforced)—> [Envoy Sidecar] —> [Envoy Sidecar] —> [Booking Service]

6.2 Strict Mutual TLS (mTLS) Encryption & Traffic Management

```
apiVersion: security.istio.io/v1beta1
kind: PeerAuthentication
metadata:
  name: default
  namespace: easyservice-prod
spec:
  mtls:
    mode: STRICT
```

6.3 Comprehensive Microservices Testing Pyramid

Testing distributed microservices requires a structured approach across all pyramid layers:



E2E Selenium Automation (5%)

Integration & Contract (20%)

Unit & Domain Logic Tests (75%)

6.4 EasyService Break-Test Specification & Defect Metric Analysis

During break-testing execution, 100 boundary test cases were run against the marketplace. Key metrics: - **Total Test Cases Executed:** 100 - **Passed Test Cases:** 97 - **Defects Identified & Resolved:** 3 (BR-02 Unverified User Lockout, BR-07 Inventory Depletion Guard, BR-15 Concurrency Lock) - **Defect Density:** 0.03 defects / test case.



Practical Lab 6: Production Service Mesh Infrastructure & Automated Verification Walkthrough

Task Objective: Execute canary deployments (90% v1 / 10% v2) using Istio VirtualService destination rules and verify zero-downtime rollouts.

```
apiVersion: networking.istio.io/v1alpha3
kind: VirtualService
metadata:
  name: booking-service-route
spec:
  hosts:
  - booking-service
  http:
  - route:
    - destination:
        host: booking-service
        subset: v1
        weight: 90
    - destination:
        host: booking-service
        subset: v2
        weight: 10
```

CHAPTER 7: CONCLUSION & FUTURE EXTENSIONS

The EasyService Marketplace project demonstrates the architectural power, operational scalability, and business agility gained by decomposing monolithic applications into cloud-native microservices. By combining **Domain-Driven Design**, **Database per Service**, **JWT Security with Ethiopian Fayda Verification**, **Resilience4j Circuit Breakers**, **Saga Distributed Transactions**, and **Istio Service Mesh**, EasyService provides an enterprise-ready foundation capable of handling real-world consumer traffic.

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